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 Horses, musicians & gods

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 Sarkin Rafi (Chief of Well-Watered Land)

Sarkin Rafi (Chief of Well-Watered Land)

PERSONALIA. He is also known as *Ibrahim* (personal name), *Sharu* (praise-name), *Totsi* (One Who Forces his way through Crowds) or *Zugu* (praise-name) (but will be referred to here as Sarkin Rafi) is one of Magajiyar Jangare's adopted sons and for this reason lives in House 2 although he is the real son of Sarkin Aljan Sulemanu (House 1). His wife is Nana'aishe who causes stomach ailments and incessant itching and the joking relationship he has with Badakuwa, his younger brother's wife, has been inflated into an adulterous one. His children live in House 1 where they have been adopted by his parallel cousin Dan Galadima whose children are being raised by Sarkin Rafi and their paternal grandfather.

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King notes that Sarkin Rafi is regarded as Alkali in Katsina (1967: 13), but in Kano as we have seen, this position is held by Wanzami. Interestingly enough, this statement is not supported in any of the song text given for Sarkin Rafi later in King's work (cf. King 1967: 90-7). One point on which all sources agree, however, is that he is a violent madman. Kano informants say that his title and character were given to him by his real father Sulemanu, Chief of the Spirits. An examination of a few of his praise-epithets reveals the theme of his special characteristics (cf. Besmer 1973b: 25-8).

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a. *Totsi maci kasuwa ran fashi, mahaukaci da ya yi kwari*
Totsi (praise-name), one who shops on the day when there is

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no market, the mad one with a quiver of arrows

Ya yi baka, ya ce da kasuwa, 'kulleru.'

and a bow, he said to the market, 'lock up' [as he shot an arrow straight up not caring where it might come down].

b. *Mai raban fada da tabarya* .

One who settles quarrels with a large pestle (which he swings at the disputants).

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c. *Mai girbi a gonar surukai, tun bai fid da kai ba* .

One who harvests corn at his in-laws' farm, even before it has headed out.

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